passion for banking. And both had the same pioneering spirit which made them ready to provide finance for projects which conventional bankers fought shy of.[28]

Nanporia refers to a letter in which Sorabji assures Sir Phiroze Sethna that he 'need not worry about the London Bank' and 'I am taking all necessary precautions'.[29] E.F. Cockell, the Bank's London agent also appears to have been keeping an eye on Sorabji and apprising Sir Phiroze of the progress. He wrote to Sir Phiroze, 'In the meantime you may rest assured that I shall not hesitate to give a candid view should I find it necessary to do so. I am however coming to the conclusion that all is well. I am glad that P came over.'[30] It was obvious that the Board wanted an independent opinion just in case Sorabji's enthusiasm got the better of him and the bank's interest suffered due to any hasty decision he might take. But Sorabji was not blind to the dangers involved, and if observers are to be believed, had taken steps to ensure that if his experiment failed, it would not entail a great loss to the bank. Soon after, Sorabji contemplated similar branches elsewhere abroad, including Japan.

Fate however had other plans. One of the vexations of mortality is a lack of prescience of the future. Though no one would have guessed it then, Sorabji's life had almost run its course. In May 1937, Sorabji returned to Bombay from Calcutta, suffering from a small boil which ultimately proved to be fatal. The boil was diagnosed as a carbuncle which doctors said would take two months to heal. Sakerbai was to leave for London with their daughters to meet sons, Rattan and Noshir at the end of the month, and Sorabji was anxious that his ill-health not ruin the family reunion. He tried in vain to persuade his wife to undertake the journey but it was soon obvious that his illness was taking a turn for the worse; and Sorabji circumstanced by the trammels of illness was a bad patient. Impatient at having to miss office, Sorabji called for an operation which he thought would resolve the matter. The operation was performed but Sorabji developed a very high fever and was often delirious. The cause of the fever could not be ascertained. Sorabji had developed an infection which the drugs of the day could not effectively combat. Sir Phiroze Sethna visited him the day before he died. Sorabji tried to speak but could not do so. He then tried to write out a message but was unable to do so, and the message he wanted to convey remained unsaid and unwritten. But Sorabji had